



Being Accreditation Ready

Martha Mock, Debra Hart, Stephanie Smith Lee & Cate Weir

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Session Overview

Program accreditation standards

Tools developed by Think College

Accreditation process

Pilot site criteria and selection

Future of accreditation



A Decade of Progress: Developing the Program Accreditation Standards

Importance of Program Accreditation

- Benchmarks are useful for quality assurance and improvement
- Added value for institutions of higher education, college programs
- Students and parents will have a comparative measure
- Implementation will validate and strengthen programs
- Accountability for college programs

The Higher Education Opportunity Act requires NCC to convene an Accreditation Workgroup of experts to develop model program accreditation standards and identify key components of higher education programs for students with ID.

- 2011-2015 NCC AWG developed model program accreditation standards.
- 2015-2020 NCC AWG conducted a field test of the model standards
 - Sessions to gather public input
 - Surveyed programs regarding interest in becoming accredited
 - Provided a recommendation to U.S. Dept of Ed regarding developing an accreditation agency
- 2020-2025 NCC AWG develop & pilot process for program accreditation

Program Accreditation Standards: 10 Areas



MISSION



STUDENT
ACHIEVEMENT



CURRICULUM



FACULTY



FACILITY,
EQUIPMENT
AND SUPPLY



ADMINISTRATIVE
AND FISCAL
CAPACITY



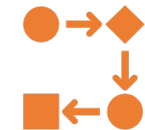
STUDENT
SERVICES



LENGTH AND
STRUCTURE OF
PROGRAM OF
STUDY



STUDENT
COMPLAINTS



PROGRAM
DEVELOPMENT,
PLANNING, AND
REVIEW



Using the Program Standards

How can the standards be used NOW?

Choose a few standards and begin your own review

Create or update program evaluation plans

Review and update program policies, procedures, handbooks

Establish a data collection system within your program

Select systems or tools to collect data for accreditation

Tools you can use...

**Introduction to
the Standards**

**Pre-
accreditation
self assessment**

**Evidence
checklist**

**System for
organizing
evidence**

**NEW! Standards
Learning
Modules**

Introducing the Program Accreditation Standards

To fully understand what is required to meet program accreditation standards, you **MUST** review the [full document that includes the precise language for each standard as well as related guidance and what is required for review](#) as evidence that the standard is being met.

This version has been created as an *introduction*, to gain a general sense of the kinds of issues that are addressed in the standards and begin to understand the overall concepts that are addressed. While it in no way captures all the nuance and detail that is required to fully understand each standard, it can serve as a general introduction for those first exploring accreditation standards for college programs for students with intellectual disability.

MISSION STANDARDS
• The program has a written mission statement consistent with Higher Education Act requirements ○ Communicated to all stakeholders ○ Reviewed regularly
STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT STANDARDS
• Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) policy that includes evaluating student progress in academics, socialization, independent living and career development. • Program level student outcomes (statement of what students are expected to learn and be able to do upon graduation) • Individualized learning plans for each student • Written report at end of each term • Established retention and pace of completion rates



**PROGRAM ACCREDITATION STANDARDS for
Higher Education Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability
Program Pre-accreditation Self-Assessment Tool**

Program Name:

Date:

Staff participating:

SELF-Assessment: This document is intended for program staff to begin exploration of the Program Accreditation Standards. There are a total of 38 standards in 10 categories. Your program can use this tool to honestly consider where your program is regarding each standard. No program is expected to have accomplished or met all, or even most, standards at this time. This tool is intended to be used as an introductory discussion and exploration of the standards.

Instructions: Meet with your college program team to familiarize yourselves with each standard. Review guidance and evidence required (provided in the [Program Accreditation Standards, Guidance and Review Requirements document](#)) to provide more context and clarity as to what each standard looks like in practice. Through careful consideration and discussion, determine how well your program is currently meeting each standard. Record your program status for each standard, using the scale below, and record and notes, questions, or concerns in the third column.



Accreditation Standards: Evidence Checklist



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100%



View only

A1:A2 fx Standard Area 2: Student Achievement

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Standard Area 2: Student Achievement		Program Self Check			
2		Evidence collected	Evidence available	Not available but easy to get/create	Needs to be developed	Notes
3	Student Achievement Standard 1					
4	The program has established a Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) policy that includes criteria for evaluating student progress in academics, socialization, independent living and career development, and the impact of such evaluation on student advancement towards program completion. The program specifies how students' advance through a full course of study and maintain satisfactory academic progress.					
5	Copy of the IHE's Satisfactory Academic Progress Policy, with description of how it is applied to program students	☐	☐	☐	☐	
6	Copy of the program's Satisfactory Academic Progress Policy, including how SAP is measured in all areas of the program's course of study (academics, socialization, career development and independent living)	☐	☐	☐	☐	
7	Student Achievement Standard 2					
8	The program has established a program level Student Learning Outcomes (SLO) assessment plan and a process that allows it to measure student achievement in varied domains including academics, social, independent living, and career development.					
9	Document detailing the student learning outcomes established for the program	☐	☐	☐	☐	



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Starred



Trash



Storage

8.73 GB of 15 GB used

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Shared with me > TEMPLATE Accreditation Standards Repository



Folders

Last modified by me ↓



10. Program Development, P...



8. Length and Structure of Pr...



2. Student Achievement



3. Curriculum



4. Faculty and Staff



1. Mission



6. Administrative and Fiscal ...



7. Student Services



9. Student Complaints



5. Facility, Equipment, and S...

Files

ThinkCollege

NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER

The National Coordinating Center
Accreditation Workgroup

Model Accreditation Program Standards for
Higher Education Programs for Students with
Intellectual Disability

September 30, 2020

These model accreditation program standards were developed by the 2015-2020 National Coordinating Center Accreditation Workgroup and will be included in the Accreditation Workgroup Report that is forthcoming.



ModelProgramAccreditation...



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NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER

INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

INTRODUCTION: ACCREDITATION STANDARDS



This module introduces the learner to the [Think College Program Accreditation Standards Learning Modules](#). It provides background information, descriptions of each module, and instructions on how to complete the series.

[Go To Module](#)

STANDARD AREA: MISSION



This module discusses [Standard Area: Mission](#) from the Accreditation Standards for Higher Education Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability, and shares resources and guidance to assist college programs in meeting this standard.

[Go To Module](#)

STANDARD AREA: FACILITIES, EQUIPMENT, AND SUPPLY



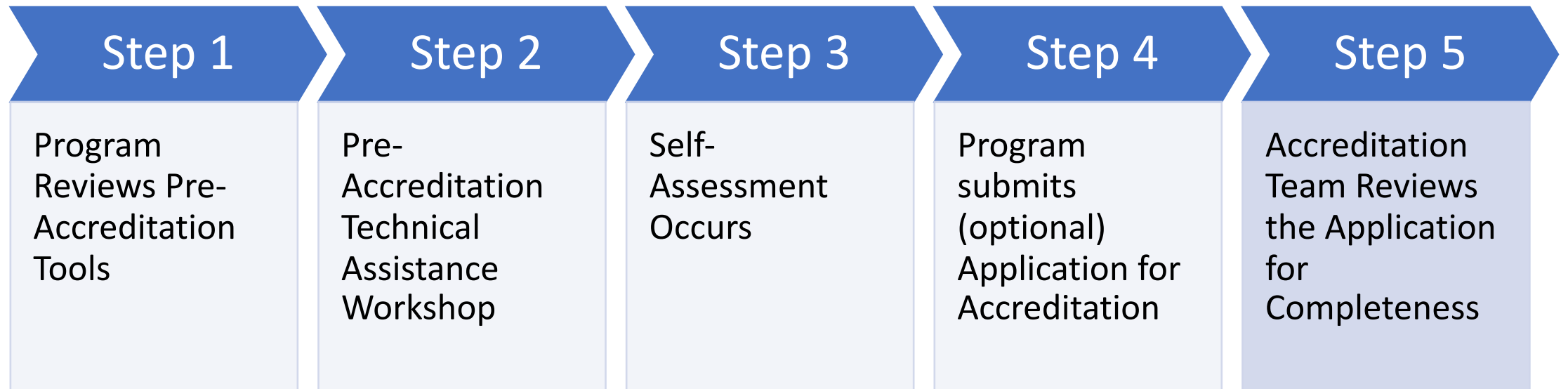
This module introduces [Standard Area: Facilities, Equipment, and Supply](#) and shares resources and guidance to assist college/university programs in meeting this standard.

[Go To Module](#)

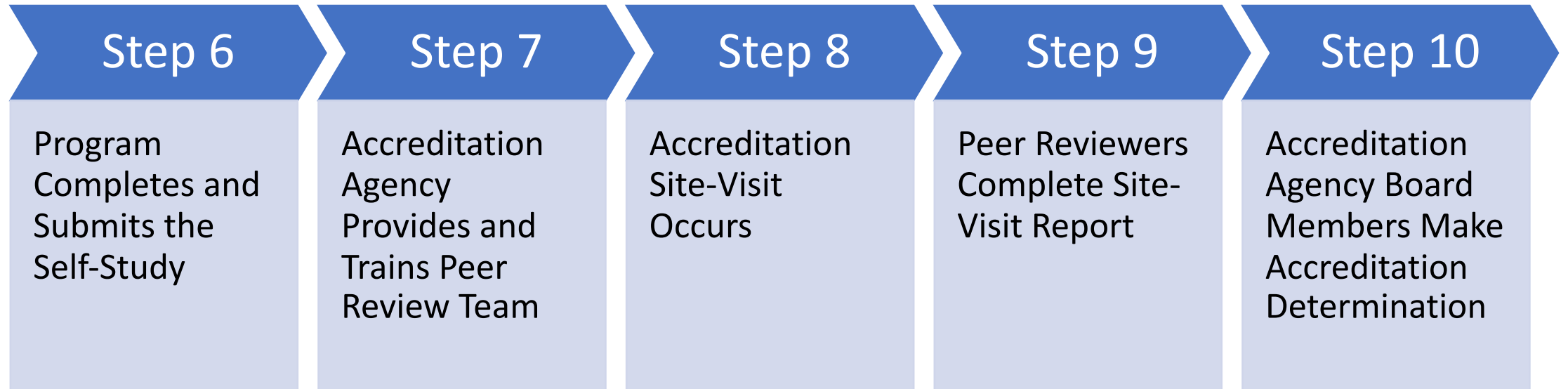
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Identifying the Essentials of Accreditation

Program Accreditation Process



Program Accreditation Process



Programs may consider accreditation if...

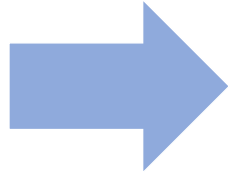
1. They are part of a nationally accredited college, university, community college or technical school with not-for-profit status.
2. Serve students with intellectual disability.
3. Meet the criteria for a Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program (CTP) in the Higher Education Opportunity Act (2008).
4. Demonstrate continuous, on-going operation of the program for at least three consecutive years immediately prior to application.
5. Graduate a minimum of three cohorts of students who have completed and earned a college approved credential.
6. Program has not had prior accreditation withdrawn by the U.S. Department of Education or another recognized accrediting agency.

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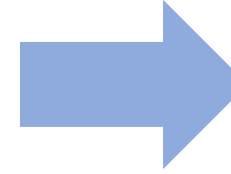
Developing the Foundation for an Accreditation Agency



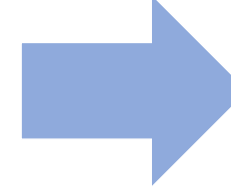
Higher Education Act
Students with ID



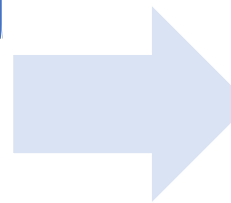
NCC Accreditation Workgroup



Model Program Standards



Pilot Accreditation Process



Programmatic Accreditation Agency

Pilot Site Recruitment - Now

Thank you Pilot Site 1!



Pilot Sites 2-5

- Established for 3+ years
- Familiar with the standards
- 3 cohorts of graduates
- College approved credential
- Enroll students with ID
- Supported by college leadership

Peer Reviewer Recruitment - Later

- Nationwide recruitment
- Current or former Program Director or Staff
- Experience with college students with ID
- Experience with accreditation is a plus
- Will receive training on the program standards and process
- Willingness to travel to site visit location
- Roles may include – team member, team lead, observer

Contact Information

Debra Hart, Co-Director,
Think College

Debra.Hart@umb.edu

Martha Mock, Chair, NCC
Accreditation Workgroup
mmock@warner.rochester.edu

Stephanie Smith Lee, Past Chair,
NCC Accreditation Workgroup

stephaniesmithlee@gmail.com

Cate Weir, Project Director, NCC at
Think College

cathryn.weir@umb.edu